



seems to have the knack of setting fields for bad deliveries too, for the catchers in the deep hardly had to move to get to the ball.

As always in recent World Cups, India and Pakistan are not only placed in the same group to ensure at least one clash between the traditional rivals, but are also invariably put in a fairly easy group to qualify for the next round. So the real battle could well start from the following stage of the tournament. Of course, as said earlier, this format is one in which unfancied teams need just one good over in each innings to turn a game around. We saw the USA beat Pakistan in the last edition of the ICC T20 World Cup when they were co-hosts with the West Indies.

They have since improved with experience and by rubbing shoulders with some of the best players in the world in Major League Cricket. The best part of these leagues is that they help to get rid of the awe factor that players from emerging countries often feel towards some of the big names in the game.

**In the driver's seat:** A 3-0 lead against New Zealand handed India its 11th consecutive T20I series win. RITU RAJ KONWAR

Sharing dressing rooms with them, seeing how they prepare, and how they deal with failure are things that cannot be taught in any university. That first-hand experience is what helps to drive their individual games forward.

India, the defending champions, are looking to repeat history by becoming the first team to defend a T20 World Cup title. It is not going to be easy at all, with teams like Australia and South Africa having just completed their own domestic T20 tournaments. Their players are match-trim, as are those from other countries who participated in these leagues.

It promises to be a nail-biter of a tournament. Then again, wasn't the standard set way back in the first ICC T20 World Cup in 2007, when India beat Pakistan in the final off the last over?

**Suryakumar Yadav is an instinctive skipper, and his calm demeanour eases the players' thought processes as they are encouraged to play the way they know best.**